Destination Nigeria: brand foundation v2.0

Source note. The executive concept note was not among the supplied files. This foundation is built from the project brief's summary of it ("Experience. Invest. Explore." and the platform description) and from the supplied logo artwork. Please check it against the concept note before external use. Where a statement depends on facts that only the client can confirm (partners, mandates, programmes, figures), it is phrased as an aspiration or left as a placeholder.

1. Brand essence

Horizons, opened. Destination Nigeria opens up the country's landscapes, cultures and opportunities to people who have not yet seen them, and makes the route to each one clear.

2. Brand purpose

To grow Nigeria's tourism economy by connecting the people who make experiences (states, communities, operators, creatives) with the people who want to enjoy them or invest in them, and to do it with clear coordination and credible information.

3. Positioning

For travellers, investors and partners who want to understand Nigeria beyond the headlines, **Destination Nigeria is** the national tourism development, investment and destination-marketing platform **that** brings together destinations, institutions, businesses and communities under one trusted, coordinated identity, **because** it combines the warmth of a destination brand with the rigour of an institution.

4. Brand promise

We will show you Nigeria as it is: varied, creative and full of opportunity. We will give you what you need to experience it, invest in it and explore it with confidence.

5. Brand personality

Trait	We are	We are not
Ambitious	Confident about what Nigeria offers; future-facing	Boastful or exaggerated
Welcoming	Warm, generous, hospitable in tone	Overfamiliar or slangy in institutional settings
Credible	Precise, sourced, organised	Bureaucratic or opaque
Curious	Hungry to discover; specific about places and people	Generic ("vibrant Africa")
Contemporary	Creative and current; Nigerian design and talent first	Trend-chasing or stereotypical

6. Brand values

1. **Authenticity.** We tell real stories about real places, credit the people behind them, and never fabricate.
2. **Coordination.** One platform and one voice, built in partnership with states, institutions and communities.
3. **Opportunity.** Tourism as an engine for livelihoods, enterprise and investment.
4. **Stewardship.** Responsible tourism that protects heritage, nature and host communities.
5. **Excellence.** International standards in service, information and presentation.

7. Audiences

Primary - Domestic travellers and the Nigerian diaspora planning visits home - International leisure and cultural travellers - Tourism investors, developers, financiers and development partners - Federal, state and local tourism institutions and agencies (as collaborators)

Secondary - Tourism operators, hospitality businesses, guides and transport providers - Host communities, cultural custodians and creative practitioners - Media, trade press and travel influencers - Corporate sponsors and event partners

8. Messaging hierarchy

1. **Proposition (campaign line):** EXPERIENCE. INVEST. EXPLORE.
2. **Platform statement:** Destination Nigeria is a national platform for tourism development, investment and destination marketing.
3. **Pillars**

Pillar	For	Core message	Proof points to develop (to be verified)
Experience	Travellers, diaspora	Nigeria's culture, food, festivals, music and hospitality, met first-hand.	Curated destination features; festival calendar; operator directory
Invest	Investors, partners	Tourism is an investable, coordinated sector with real projects.	Investment profiles with verified data; partner frameworks
Explore	Everyone	Landscapes from coast to plateau to savannah; routes made clear.	Destination maps; itineraries; visitor information

4. **Supporting messages:** responsible tourism, community benefit, creative economy, institutional coordination.
5. **Calls to action:** Plan your visit · Explore investment profiles · Partner with us · Get media resources.

9. Tone of voice

Clear, warm, assured. Use short sentences. Use specific nouns: name the place, the dish, the festival, the person. Use active verbs.

Context	Dial	Example
Campaign / social	Warmer, more evocative	"Nigeria, one place at a time."
Destination feature	Descriptive, sensory, factual	"At first light the rock turns from grey to amber. Bring water and good shoes."
Investment / institutional	Precise, structured, measured	"This profile summarises the opportunity, its development stage and the documentation available on request."
Media	Neutral, attributable	"Destination Nigeria today announced…" (with verified facts only)

Do: write "Nigeria's" not "Africa's"; credit communities and photographers; use numbers only when they are sourced. **Don't:** use clichés ("hidden gem", "land of contrasts", "vibrant tapestry"); overclaim (the "biggest" or "best" without a source); stereotype; imply endorsements or schedules that have not been confirmed.

Style points: British English spelling, as used in Nigerian official writing. Write "Destination Nigeria" in full on first mention; never abbreviate it to "DN" in public copy. Write the proposition in sentence case with full stops: *Experience. Invest. Explore.*

10. Visual identity principles (v2)

1. **The land, drawn and photographed.** The logo is a drawing of a real kind of place. The identity extends it with real photographs of real places and engraved plates traced from those photographs. Nothing is invented.
2. **The horizon composition.** Every layout is divided by a horizon, the way the logo is: land above, words below. Its height changes with the job (low for campaign, high for reports), so

compositions vary while the system stays recognisable.

3. **One sun.** Sun Gold is the sun: the logo's disc, one disc in a plate, one figure or one call to action. It is never decoration.
4. **Captions name the place.** Every photograph and plate carries its place and state. Specificity is the brand's signature, not ornament.
5. **Two families, three roles.** Newsreader Display for titles, Newsreader Text for reading, Public Sans for information (with ₦ and tabular figures).
6. **Craft over effects.** No gradients, glows, ribbons, rings, patterns, seals, rounded cards or shadows. Paper, Forest, hairlines and considered space.

Visual territory: "The land, drawn and photographed"

- **Inselberg.** Nigeria's granite domes (Zuma, Idanre, Olumo) rise abruptly from the plain. The logo draws that landform; the plates engrave real ones.
- **Sun disc.** Warmth and arrival. It is used once per composition.
- **Horizon.** A photograph's edge, a plate's edge or a hairline. It structures every layout.
- **Engraved plates.** Line engravings in the tradition of banknotes, stamps and survey plates, each traced from a verified photograph of the place it names.

Cultural references beyond these landforms (textiles such as *aso-oke* or *adire*, architecture, scripts) should only be added in collaboration with the communities and practitioners they belong to, with credit. Don't use them as generic ornament.